AYDEN YOUNG

SUMMARY

PhD Candidate in Economics at the University of California, Santa Cruz. Research applies causal inference and large-scale administrative data to housing markets, consumer credit, and public infrastructure. Experienced working in secure data environments and communicating findings to technical and non-technical audiences. Available to start full-time starting December 2026.

SKILLS

- **Causal Inference & Methods:** Difference-in-Differences, Matching (propensity score, feature distance), Regression Discontinuity, Instrumental Variables, Synthetic Control, A/B Testing, Double Machine Learning, Forest Methods
- **Programming & Data Tools:** R (proficient), Python (proficient), SQL, Haver Analytics, Tableau; spatial analysis in R (sf, tigris, tidycensus)
- **Data Environments:** Secure data hub administration (California Policy Lab), large-scale administrative panel data, consumer credit records, FHWA infrastructure data

EMPLOYMENT

- San José State University • Lecturer • Aug 2026 – Present
  - Sole instructor of record for Intermediate Macroeconomics (Econ 102); responsible for course design, lectures, and assessment.
- University of California at Santa Cruz • Graduate Student Instructor • Aug 2025 – Aug 2026
  - Instructor of record for Intermediate Macroeconomics (Econ 100b).
- University of California at Santa Cruz • Teaching Assistant • Aug 2022 – Aug 2025
  - Supported instruction across eight courses including Econometrics, Public Finance, and Python for Data Science.
- Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation • Student Trainee Economist • Jan 2022 – Aug 2022
  - Produced economic reports and data dashboards for internal policy audiences, meeting 508-compliance standards for clear, accessible communication to non-technical readers.
  - Maintained economic datasets in Haver Analytics; developed Excel-based reporting tools for regional economists.

ayoung14@ucsc.edu feusen.github.io October 2026

POLICY RESEARCH

3. Does Strong Credit Overcome Racial Discrimination in Rental Housing? (with P. Christensen & J. West)
   Job Market Paper; draft available on website
   - Links experimental audit data on housing discrimination to panel consumer credit records, finding evidence that strong credit can partially offset discrimination in rental housing. Conducted in R and SQL in the California Policy Lab's Secure Data Hub.
   - Bears on fair lending policy, tenant screening regulation, and the credit consequences of discrimination.
2. Bridge Sufficiency and Shared Maintenance Responsibilities (with J. Marion)
   Draft in preparation
   - Examines how shared maintenance responsibility between two state agencies affects the condition of interstate bridges, using FHWA administrative data on over 600,000 bridge inspections.
   - Applies Mahalanobis matching and panel methods to estimate the relationship between jurisdictional structure and bridge condition; informs intergovernmental infrastructure policy.
1. Guest Speaker, HUD Office of Economic Affairs Research Roundtable • Oct 2026

EDUCATION

- University of California at Santa Cruz • PhD in Economics • Aug 2022 – Exp. June 2027
- University of California at Santa Cruz • MA in Economics • 2023
- University of Illinois at Chicago • BS in Economics and Applied Statistics (Summa Cum Laude) • 2022

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Dissertation Year Fellowship, UCSC • $19,000 • 2026–2027
- Institute for Social Transformation Catalyze Award (with J. West) • $9,500 • 2025
- Dissertation Research Grant, UCSC • $9,500 • 2025
- Regents Fellowship, UCSC • $16,000 • 2022–2023

REFERENCES

- Justin Marion • Professor, UCSC • Advisor and coauthor
- Peter Christensen • Associate Professor, UCSC • Committee chair and coauthor
- Jeremy West • Associate Professor, UCSC • Coauthor